

» COLUBRIDS

1.4 m
4½ ft**COMMON TRINKET SNAKE***Coelognathus helena*

This Indian species enlarges its neck and rises up to intimidate its enemies. It hunts mammals, usually at night.

1.6 m
5¼ ft**ROUGH GREEN SNAKE***Opheodrys aestivus*

Native to woodlands in southeastern N. America, this arboreal snake is a diurnal predator of insects. It is oviparous.

2.4 m
7¾ ft**RED-TAILED GREEN RATSNAKE***Gonyosoma oxycephalum*

This fast-moving snake hunts for birds and mammals in trees. It is found in the rainforests of S.E. Asia.

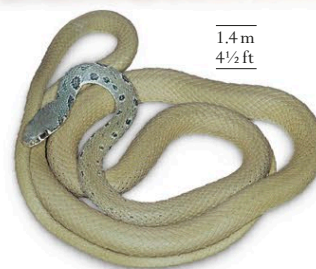
long, slender body

60 cm
23½ in**SMOOTH SNAKE***Coronella austriaca*

This secretive European snake is found on heaths and kills its prey by constriction. Females produce eggs that hatch within their bodies.

1 m
3¼ in**BALKAN WHIPSNAKE***Hierophis gemonensis*

Restricted to the Balkans, this snake is found in dry scrubland and olive groves. It hunts during the day, preying on lizards.

1.4 m
4½ ft**DAHL'S WHIPSNAKE***Platyceps najadum*

From the Mediterranean region, this snake is found in dry, stony habitats. It hunts small lizards and grasshoppers during the day.

1.6 m
5¼ ft**SOUTHERN WATER SNAKE***Nerodia fasciata*

Living in wetlands, this colubrid preys on amphibians and fish. It is found in the S. USA.

20 cm
8 in**BROWN-HEADED CENTIPEDE SNAKE***Tantilla ruficeps*

This burrowing snake is found in the tropical forests of C. America. It is a mainly diurnal insect-eater.

head with prominent eyes
pale underside1.8 m
6 ft**WESTERN HOGNOSED SNAKE***Heterodon nasicus*

This snake of the N. American prairies uses its specialized, enlarged teeth to puncture the lungs of toads, making them easier to swallow.

brown markings on muscular body

1.8 m
6 ft**RED CORNSNAKE***Pantherophis guttatus*

This snake is common in southeastern N. America, but is rarely seen. It hunts small mammals in woodland.

2 m
6½ ft**YELLOW RATSNAKE***Spilotes pullatus*

A predator of small vertebrates, this large snake is rarely found far from water. It is widely distributed in S. and C. America.

80 cm
32 in**MOLE VIPER***Atractaspis fallax*

This poisonous snake from E. Africa has large front fangs. It hunts other burrowing vertebrates underground.

75 cm
30 in**MONTPELLIER SNAKE***Malpolon monspessulanus*

Inhabiting dry scrub and rocky hillsides around the Mediterranean, this long, slender snake hunts small vertebrates during the day.

1.8 m
6 ft**GIANT MALAGASY HOGNOSE SNAKE***Leioheterodon madagascariensis*

This large, diurnal snake, with an upturned snout, hunts lizards and amphibians in grasslands and forests in Madagascar.

ASIAN PIPE SNAKES

Found in Sri Lanka and S.E. Asia, these small, burrowing snakes of the Cylindrophidae have a cylindrical body and smooth, shiny scales. They live in wet habitats, sheltering in tunnels, but emerge at night to hunt other snakes and eels. They give birth to live young.

CEYLONESE PIPE SNAKE*Cylindrophis maculatus*

Endemic to Sri Lanka, this harmless burrowing snake eats invertebrates. It uses its flattened tail to mimic the movements of the venomous cobra.

65 cm
26 in

SEA SNAKES

These highly venomous snakes from the tropical coastal waters of the Indian and Pacific oceans belong to the subfamily Hydrophiinae, part of the larger Elapidae. They are well adapted for swimming, with a paddle-like tail. All but a few breed in water, bearing live young. They eat eels and other fish.

YELLOW-LIPPED SEAKRAIT*Laticauda colubrina*

This snake hunts fish at night in tropical Indo-Pacific seas. It can move on land as well.

1.4 m
4½ ft